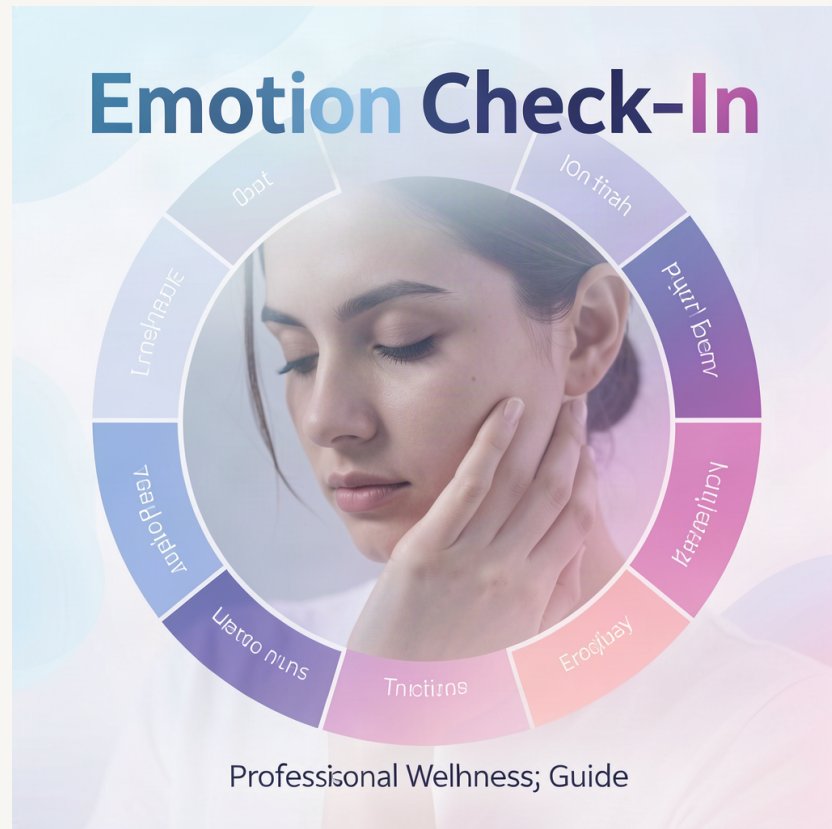




Emotion Check-In

Name the feeling, notice the need, choose one supportive next step

Use a brief check-in to turn a vague feeling into a clearer need and one doable next action.

Emotion Check-In

Older children with support, teens, adults, educators and caregivers

A feeling is information, not a command

Pause long enough to name what is happening. You do not have to fix the feeling immediately. Notice it, understand its context, and choose a next step that supports you.

How to use this tool

Work through the pages in any order. Use a pen, pencil, or digital annotation tool. Keep what helps; leave what does not.

Important

This reflection tool does not diagnose a mental-health condition. Seek qualified support for persistent or severe symptoms. If you may be in immediate danger or cannot stay safe, contact emergency services or an appropriate crisis resource now.

My right-now check-in

Right now I feel... (choose one broad word, then a more specific word)

Intensity: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Body clues I notice (jaw, shoulders, chest, stomach, hands, head, other)

Before this feeling, I was...

I was with... / I was thinking...

What I may need now: rest, food, movement, quiet, reassurance, information, connection, space, or help

My right-now check-in (continued)

My two-minute next step

Emotion word bank

Calm

steady, settled, safe, content

Sad

disappointed, lonely, hurt, grieving

Angry

irritated, resentful, frustrated, furious

Afraid

worried, nervous, uneasy, alarmed

Joyful

excited, proud, grateful, playful

Tired

drained, overwhelmed, numb, restless

Confused

uncertain, conflicted, stuck, surprised

Hopeful

encouraged, relieved, curious, determined

Seven-day pattern tracker

Day / strongest feeling / intensity

What happened before it?

What need showed up?

What helped even a little?

A pattern I notice

A compassionate next sentence

Complete this without judging yourself.

It makes sense that I might feel ___ because ___.

I can allow this feeling and still choose ___.

One person, place, or resource that may help is ___.

Sources and use note

This printable tool was designed with general self-care and coping concepts from the sources below. It is educational material, not health care or therapy.

National Institute of Mental Health: Caring for Your Mental Health

Self-care, connection, stress-management framing

<https://www.nimh.nih.gov/health/topics/caring-for-your-mental-health>

National Institute of Mental Health: So Stressed Out

Journaling, relaxation, mindfulness, sleep, and support concepts

<https://www.nimh.nih.gov/health/publications/so-stressed-out-fact-sheet>

NHS: Breathing exercises for stress

Comfortable, unforced breathing guidance

<https://www.nhs.uk/mental-health/self-help/guides-tools-and-activities/breathing-exercises-for-stress/>

WebMD: What Is Box Breathing?

Optional paced-breathing presentation

<https://www.webmd.com/balance/what-is-box-breathing>

WebMD: Quick Stress-Relief Rituals

Sensory grounding context

<https://www.webmd.com/depression/quick-stress-relief-rituals>

American Psychological Association: Stress management tips

Thought, emotion, behavior, and reframing context

<https://www.apa.org/topics/stress/tips>

CASEL: Fundamentals of SEL

Emotion identification and self-management framing

<https://casel.org/fundamentals-of-sel/>

CDC: Information for Family Caregivers

Caregiver capacity, breaks, and support framing

<https://www.cdc.gov/disability-and-health/about/information-for-family-caregivers.html>

Child Mind Institute: How to Help Children Calm Down

Coping-ahead and child-friendly calming support

<https://childmind.org/article/how-to-help-children-calm-down/>

Wikipedia: Mindfulness

Plain-language background only; not clinical authority

<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mindfulness>

Reddit community discussions

User-centered presentation inspiration only; not clinical authority

https://www.reddit.com/r/Anxiety/comments/1ch67c8/making_an_anxiety_tool_box_what_should_i_put_in_it/

YouTube guided box-breathing example

Visual pacing inspiration only; not clinical authority

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tEmt1Znux58>